



# David Celis Backend Engineer

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## ABOUT ME

I'm an empathy-driven backend engineer specializing in designing elegant APIs with a keen eye toward usability and maintainability. I strive for a user-first approach, understanding that people come from a variety of backgrounds that differ from my own, while also producing readable, well-tested, and well-measured code. Outside of work, I'm an avid Open Source Software advocate. I've maintained several open source libraries and have directly contributed to many more, including Ruby on Rails, bundler, Discourse, Hanami, and fish.

## SKILLS

**Ruby** — Rails, Sorbet

**API Design** — REST, GraphQL

**Git** — GitHub

**SQL** — PostgreSQL

## WORK

### **Freshworks / FireHydrant** 🔗, Senior Staff Software Engineer

Jul 2021 – Now  
Remote, USA

I maintained a highly collaborative partnership with management and product to guide the team's roadmap, architecture, and overall process/health while leading large-scale projects across engineering. I helped lead development of FireHydrant's alerting and on-call product, Signals, both designing and implementing many of its most foundational systems. Signals lead to a 10x increase in customers and 6.4x ARR growth over two years, directly leading to FireHydrant's acquisition by Freshworks. After Signals, I lead an overhaul of FireHydrant's entire authorization layer, designing and building a new RBAC system using Authzed to allow customers to fulfill a request they had for years: custom roles with granular permissions. After joining Freshworks, I lead a project to implement a migration tool that would allow customers to import teams with escalation policies and on-call schedules into FireHydrant from Opsgenie and PagerDuty with the click of a button.

### **Stripe** 🔗, Staff Software Engineer

Nov 2019 – May 2021  
Remote, USA

I began on Stripe's API Platform team, leading a company-wide audit of their heavily-used feature flagging system to determine the purpose, ownership, and intended lifecycle of every single feature flag that had been created. This audit had immense and lasting impact on how Stripe engineers approached their use of feature flags, drastically reducing the number of flags being created for private, one-off features. After my time on API Platform, I moved to work on Stripe's Issuing product to act as engineering lead for the launch of a brand new Commercial Payout Card product, a five month project spanning almost ten separate workstreams and over a dozen other engineers.

### **HashiCorp** 🔗, Senior Software Engineer

Nov 2017 – Nov 2019  
Remote, USA

At HashiCorp, I worked on Terraform Cloud (TFC), a product that added remote state storage and collaborative features to Terraform. I joined HashiCorp's team responsible for TFC's REST APIs, its integration with Sentinel (an embeddable policy-as-code framework) and, occasionally, tinkering with its Ember frontend or surrounding Go microservices. At HashiCorp, I lead several large projects, including preparing version 2 of the API for exiting its beta status, a new administration API for Terraform Enterprise, Sentinel Policy Sets 🔗, and a Cost Estimation 🔗 feature.

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| <b>GitHub</b>  , Software Engineer<br>As a member of GitHub's Ecosystem Engineering organization, I shared responsibility for building and maintaining GitHub's developer APIs, third-party integrations, webhooks, and developer documentation. I was a member of the team that shipped the pre-release of GitHub's GraphQL API, after which I spent my time on the Identity Access Management (IAM) team shipping Business accounts and GitHub Apps. I also onboarded myself onto GitHub's main on-call rotation after only three months on the job. At my final performance review, I was told that my on-call logs were consistently amongst the best at the company. | Jan 2016 – Oct 2017<br>Remote, USA       |
| <b>IMMUNIO</b> , Software Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Apr 2015 – Dec 2015<br>Remote, USA       |
| <b>DigitalOcean</b>  , Software Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Aug 2014 – Mar 2015<br>Remote, USA       |
| <b>New Relic</b>  , Senior Software Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Oct 2012 – Aug 2014<br>Portland, OR, USA |
| <b>DECK Monitoring</b> , Software Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | May 2011 – Jul 2012<br>Portland, OR, USA |

## PROJECTS

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| <b>block-kit</b> , a powerful, elegant way to build UI for Slack applications<br>Slack's Block Kit UI framework has many built-in limits, from text length to which blocks are supported in which surfaces, but they don't publish their JSON Schema. FireHydrant customers rely heavily on our Slack application so, to avoid errors from Slack, I created an elegant DSL powered by ActiveSupport with documented limits codified as Rails validations, most of which the gem can fix for users automatically. | Apr 2025 – Now      |
| <b>Nook Stop API</b>  , a GraphQL demo based on Animal Crossing<br>I delivered a tech talk to coworkers at FireHydrant about GraphQL and wrote an overly comprehensive API using data from Animal Crossing: New Horizons.                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Jun 2022 – Now      |
| <b>Sparkles</b>  , an appreciation/recognition bot for Slack                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Oct 2021 – Now      |
| <b>Rack::Console</b>  , `rails console` for everything                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Jul 2014 – Now      |
| <b>Recommendable</b>  , a binary recommendation system                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Jan 2012 – Apr 2018 |
| <b>Crêpe</b>  , a lightweight API framework for Ruby                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Sep 2013 – Dec 2017 |
| <b>Sunscreen</b>  , a macOS app for dynamic wallpapers                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Feb 2016 – Mar 2016 |
| <b>goodbre.ws</b>  , a recommendation site for beer<br>A recommendation site for beer using likes/dislikes instead of a five-star system. It was unexpectedly featured on Lifehacker  and The Huffington Post  .                                        | Jan 2011 – Mar 2014 |

## EDUCATION

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| <b>B.A.H. in Computer Science</b> , Rollins College <br>I graduated summa cum laude in the top 5 of my class with a 3.99 GPA (4.0 Major GPA) and was on the President's List for all terms. | 2007 – 2011<br>Winter Park, FL, USA |
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